

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF RICHMOND

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PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI,

SUMMONS

Plaintiff,

Index No.:

-against-

The Basis of Venue is:

NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN, Shield No.
3274, and POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE 1-10,

Location of Incident

Defendants.

Plaintiff designates Richmond
County as the place of trial.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the verified complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the verified complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
December 1, 2020

Yours, etc.

CAITLIN ROBIN &
ASSOCIATES PLLC.
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street, Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026TO: NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN, Shield No. 3274, NARCBSI, 1 Police
Plaza, Room 1312, New York, NY 10038

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF RICHMOND

----- X

PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI,

INDEX NO.:

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED AMENDED
COMPLAINT

-against-

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN,
Shield No. 3274, and POLICE OFFICERS
JOHN DOE 1-10,

Defendants.

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Plaintiff, PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI, by her attorneys, Caitlin Robin & Associates, PLLC,
as and for her Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Section 1983, and of rights secured by the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution. On January 26, 2018, at approximately 11:00 A.M., plaintiff PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI was subjected to an unlawful stop, frisk, search, detention, and false imprisonment, while lawfully present inside 74 Jefferson Avenue, in Staten Island, New York. Plaintiff spent approximately 24 hours unlawfully in police custody. Thereafter, the defendant police officers denied plaintiff the right to a fair trial by forwarding false information to the District Attorney's Office. All charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed on or about June 19, 2018. Plaintiff was deprived of her constitutional rights when the individual defendants unlawfully

stopped, questioned, frisked, searched, unlawfully arrested, and denied the plaintiff the right to a fair trial in violation of the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI is a resident of the State of New York.

3. NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN, Shield No. 3274, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. On the date of the subject incident NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN, Shield No. 3274, was assigned to the NBSI.

5. NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN, Shield No. 3274, is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

6. POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE 1-10, are and were at all times relevant herein, officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

7. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

8. At all times relevant hereto, defendant CITY OF NEW YORK, operated, maintained, managed, supervised and controlled the New York City Police Department ("NYPD") as part of and in conjunction with its municipal function.

9. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

10. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

11. On January 26, 2018, at approximately 11:00 a.m., plaintiff was lawfully present inside 74 Jefferson Avenue in Staten Island, New York, when defendant officers subjected her to an unlawful stop, frisk, detention, and false imprisonment.

12. Plaintiff was lawfully present inside 74 Jefferson Avenue with her two minor children at the above time and location.

13. Defendant Police Officers barged into the apartment, with guns drawn, scaring all of the occupants.

14. Plaintiff was alone in a bedroom with her two minor daughters.

15. Defendants handcuffed Plaintiff and her fourteen (14) year old minor daughter, and physically took her forty-two (42) day old child.

16. Defendants then searched Plaintiffs person, and found no illegal contraband.

17. Plaintiff was then unlawfully placed under arrest.

18. At no time prior to being stopped by the officers did the plaintiff commit a crime or behave in a manner that gave the police officers a reasonable and objective basis to believe he had committed or was committing a crime.

19. Plaintiff asked the defendant officers why she was being arrested, but no response was given.

20. Defendants called an ambulance for the forty-two day old baby, and took her away from her mother, without permission or authority.

21. Plaintiff was then transported against her will to the NYPD 122 Precinct, where she was fingerprinted, photographed, and unlawfully detained in a holding cell.

22. Plaintiff was handcuffed to a radiator for approximately eight hours, and continually denied a phone call.

23. Plaintiff was then transported from the NYPD 122 Precinct to Richmond County Central Bookings.

24. The Defendant Officers falsely stated to the Richmond County District Attorney's Office that Plaintiff had committed the crime of Criminal Possession of a Controlled Substance knowing that they lacked a legal and factual basis to allege that Plaintiff committed any crime.

25. On January 27, 2018, after approximately twenty-four hours unlawfully in police custody, Plaintiff was arraigned in Richmond County Criminal Court and charged with crimes that the defendant officers had no basis to allege that she committed.

26. Plaintiff's case was adjourned to a later date and she was released on her own recognizance.

27. All charges were dismissed and sealed against Plaintiff in their entirety on or around June 19, 2018.

28. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent the unjustifiable stop, question, frisk, search, seizure, false arrest, and denial of fair trial, against plaintiff.

29. The unlawful stop, question, frisk, search, false arrest, false imprisonment, and unlawful seizure against the plaintiff by the individually named defendants caused the plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological, and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

30. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 29 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

31. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused plaintiff to be unlawfully stopped, questioned, frisked, seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, falsely imprisoned, subjected to denial of her due process rights in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure and denial of due process under the Fourth and Fifth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

32. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 31 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

33. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, the plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

34. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived the plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

35. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

36. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

37. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop, Question, and Frisk

38. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 37 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

39. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, questioning and frisk employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

40. The conduct of defendants in stopping, frisking, and searching, plaintiff were performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

41. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the United States Constitution

42. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

43. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

44. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

45. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 44 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

46. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop, and search employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

47. Defendants lacked probable cause to search the plaintiff.

48. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived the plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

49. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

50. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

51. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth And Fourteenth Amendment Rights

Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

52. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 51 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

53. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Richmond County District Attorney's Office.

54. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Richmond County District Attorney's Office.

55. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Richmond County District Attorney's Office.

56. In withholding/creating false evidence against plaintiff PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

57. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of her constitutional rights.

58. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

59. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

60. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

61. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 60 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

62. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff, PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to the plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

63. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to the plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

64. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

65. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

66. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

67. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

68. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 67 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

69. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train, and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

70. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

71. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 70 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

72. The defendants that did not physically touch the plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated the plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of the plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

73. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

74. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of her safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

75. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived the plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

76. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

77. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

78. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

79. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 78 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

80. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.

81. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against the plaintiff.

82. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against the plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

83. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

84. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

85. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived the plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the United States Constitution.

86. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

87. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

88. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, plaintiff PATRICIA SLIZEWSKI demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
November 24, 2020

By:  _____

CAITLIN ROBIN &
ASSOCIATES PLLC.
CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Broad Street, Suite 702
New York, New York 10004
(646)-524-6026

TO: NYPD DETECTIVE LEONID SHATKIN, Shield No. 3274, NARCBSI, 1 Police Plaza,
New York, NY 10038

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

CAITLIN ROBIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a member of the law firm of **CAITLIN ROBIN & ASSOCIATES PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
December 1, 2020



CAITLIN ROBIN, ESQ.